



CHOTU / KALIA

THE DOG I COULD SAVE, BUT COULDN'T PROTECT

A real rescue story about love, responsibility, safety—and the painful lessons that rescue can teach us.

A RESCUER'S STORY

There are some rescue stories that remain in your heart forever. Not because you failed to save a life, but because you once saved a life with everything you had—and later lost that life because you could not foresee what was coming.

This is the story of **Chotu, also known as Kalia**. And behind his story lies a lesson that I never want another rescued animal to teach me again.

THE DAY I FOUND CHOTU

Those were the days when I was working for our client, **NTPC Barh**. One day, some workers informed me about a dog who had suffered a severe injury to his right rear leg.

I immediately went there. What I saw stopped me. His leg was badly fractured, and the injury had torn through the muscle and skin. His injured bone was visibly exposed.

But what touched me even more than the injury was his face. There were tears in his eyes. He was lying near his mother. When she saw me approaching, she started crying out loudly. It felt as if she was trying to tell me something.

Perhaps she knew me. Perhaps she trusted me. And perhaps, in her own way, she was asking me to save her child.

WHY THE DOGS TRUSTED ME

Inside NTPC Barh, I regularly fed around **25 street dogs**. My normal routine was simple.

When I entered the premises around **9–10 AM**, I searched for them and fed them according to what was available—*chuda with biscuits*, *chuda with milk*, or *chuda with bhura*. After feeding them, I made sure they had clean drinking water.

In the evening, around **5 PM**, I repeated the same routine. Sometimes, because of urgent field work, I could not find every dog during the morning or evening round. But whenever my schedule allowed, I came earlier, searched for the missing dogs, called them, fed them and gave them water.

For me, it was not simply feeding animals. Over time, they became like a family. Even the dogs who initially refused to come near me—including some of the alpha dogs—slowly began trusting me.

I COULDN'T LEAVE CHOTU THERE

Looking at Chotu's condition, I knew he needed immediate help.

I called my respected youngest friend, **Anshu Vishwakarma**. Anshu is a very simple, kind-hearted and emotional person.

I asked him to help me get Chotu out of the NTPC premises and bring him to my tiny rented room in Barh. He immediately arranged a vehicle. He even helped convince the CISF personnel so that Chotu could be taken out safely.

And finally, this injured one-year-old male dog reached my **10 × 10 ft rented room**. I had not even informed my room owner. But at that moment, I wasn't thinking about the room. I was thinking only about Chotu.

I TOOK LEAVE FOR HIM

I took leave from my company, **NEVCO ENGINEERS PVT. LTD.** Fortunately, my company trusted me and allowed me **seven days of leave**. I will always remain grateful for that understanding.

At that time, our Zonal Manager was **Mr. Antaryami Samantray**. He was a soft-spoken, kind-hearted and very down-to-earth person. He treated me like his younger brother, and I have always respected him deeply.

Because of that support, I could give Chotu the attention he desperately needed.

THE FIGHT TO SAVE HIS LEG

The next day, I contacted **Mr. Mithilesh Sir** from the Government Animal College-cum-Hospital near Bailey Road, Patna.

He advised me to bring Chotu to the hospital first. The doctors would then determine the appropriate treatment and whether his leg could be saved.

I immediately took Chotu there by reserved auto. We reached early in the morning.

The doctor examined him and gave me a difficult choice: **Remove the leg—or try to save it.**

My answer was immediate: **"Save his leg."**

The doctor asked me to return after three days. I did exactly that.

THE RAINY DAY

Three days later, it was raining heavily. We reached the hospital around **9 AM**. But that day, we could not get an OT slot.

I requested them again and again. I explained that I had travelled from far away with an injured dog and asked them to please help us.

Sir finally told me that Chotu would be attended to the next day. And he kept his promise.

The following day, Chotu was taken into the OT. After approximately two and a half hours, he came back. The surgery had been successful.

Chotu was unconscious after the operation. When he regained consciousness, the doctor explained his care requirements to me. I took him back to my little rented room in Barh.

CHOTU BECAME MY CHILD

Day by day, Chotu started improving. He slept beside me. He trusted me. He began behaving as if I was his father.

Gradually, he started walking inside the room—lifting his operated rear leg from the ground. For me, every tiny improvement felt like a victory.

I had brought him home broken. Now I was watching him slowly stand again.

THEN CHOTU MET BABY

At night, another little life was under my care—a baby goat named **Baby**. I used to feed her and spend time playing with her.

One night, Chotu met Baby. And something beautiful happened. They started playing together.

After playing, Chotu returned to the room and slept on the bed. This slowly became their routine.

For a while, my tiny room felt like a little world of rescued lives.

BUT I HAD TOO MANY LIVES DEPENDING ON ME

At that time, I was carrying several responsibilities simultaneously.

First, there was **Pagulu, Pagili and their family of 11 dogs**.

Second, there were **Pikku, Kallu and five others**.

Third, there was **Baby, the goat**.

Fourth, there was **Chotu**.

And fifth, there were around **20 street dogs** whom I was caring for outside.

Along with all of this came my **office responsibilities and family responsibilities**. Many times, I became completely exhausted.

That was when I started dreaming of something very simple: a place where I could keep these rescued animals safely and separately.

I imagined a place where I would not need a separate rented room anymore—a place that would feel like **heaven**, not because it was luxurious, but because every rescued life would finally be safe.

THE PLAN FOR CHOTU

After some months, I started thinking about socialising Chotu with Pagulu-Pagili's family.

Their area had a close fence, a single room and some outer space where the dogs could move and play. Pikku and Kallu's area had three sides surrounded by walls and one open side.

I began the socialisation process gradually, especially during holidays and festivals when I could spend more time observing them.

After around 15 days, I started feeling that Chotu was becoming comfortable with Pagulu-Pagili's family.

Everything seemed to be going according to my expectations—until the mating season arrived.

THE WARNING I DIDN'T UNDERSTAND

During that period, I sometimes noticed increased aggression among four male dogs in Pagulu-Pagili's family.

But I never imagined that Chotu could become involved in a serious incident.

One night, while I was feeding them, I noticed aggression in Chotu's behaviour in my presence. I had seen similar behaviour on some days before. So I ignored it.

I thought it would pass. I thought I understood them.

I was wrong.

THE MORNING THAT DESTROYED ME

Early the next morning, I found Chotu dead.

His surgically repaired rear leg had been badly injured again. There was little blood. There was mud around his mouth. And he was gone.

The same dog whose leg I had fought so hard to save... The same dog who had slept beside me... The same dog who had slowly learned to walk again... Was lying lifeless in front of me.

That morning, something inside me went completely dark.

I kept asking myself: **“How could I not understand what was happening?” “Why didn't I read the warning signs?” “Why didn't I separate him that night?”**

A GRAVEYARD, A SMALL GRAVE AND A BROKEN HEART

I buried Chotu in a graveyard. It was dark. It was late at night. And I was crying and screaming.

I had once carried him to the hospital hoping to save his leg. Now I was carrying him to his final resting place.

I had saved him once. But I could not protect him forever.

That thought broke me.

WHAT CHOTU TAUGHT ME

After returning to my room, I kept asking God for one thing:

“Give me the wisdom to recognise danger before it becomes a tragedy.”

Animals cannot always tell us when something is going wrong. Sometimes their behaviour changes before something happens. Sometimes a small warning is all we get.

And sometimes, if we miss that warning, there is no second chance.

Chotu's story taught me that **rescue is not only about treatment**. It is also about safe space, controlled socialisation, observation, separation when necessary, emergency access and constant protection.

WHY A SAFE RESCUE SPACE MATTERS

Today, when I think about Chotu, I realise that **love alone is not enough**. A rescuer needs a safe environment to protect the animals properly.

A rescue shelter needs:

A wide, secure area with a strong and reliable fence and a safe main entrance.

A weatherproof 6 × 6 ft cage or isolation space where an injured, recovering, aggressive or newly rescued animal can be kept safely when required.

And equally important: **quick access to medical attention**, either through a nearby veterinary hospital or reliable transportation for emergency treatment.

If I had such a facility then, perhaps Chotu's story could have been different. I will never know. And that uncertainty is something I will carry with me forever.

CHOTU IS GONE. BUT HIS STORY SHOULD NOT BE.

Chotu was not just another street dog.

He was a life that trusted me. He was a patient who survived a terrible injury. He was a dog who fought through surgery. He was a companion to Baby. He was a child who slept beside me.

And finally, he became the lesson that changed the way I think about rescue.

I cannot bring Chotu back. But I can make sure that his death is not meaningless.

His story reminds me why every rescued animal needs more than food and medicine.

They need **space**. They need **security**. They need **observation**. They need **emergency medical support**.

And above everything else, they need someone who is able to protect them when they cannot protect themselves.

Chotu, I am sorry.

I saved your leg. But I could not save you.

If I ever get the opportunity to build a proper rescue space, a part of that place will always belong to you.

Because you were not only one of the dogs I rescued.

You were one of the reasons I learned what rescue truly means.

THE DREAM THAT REMAINS

My dream is not to build a luxurious shelter.

My dream is to build a **safe home for rescued lives**—with enough open space, reliable fencing, a secure entrance, weatherproof isolation facilities and the ability to reach veterinary care quickly whenever an emergency happens.

A place where an injured animal does not have to depend on luck.

A place where a rescuer can separate animals immediately when their behaviour becomes unsafe.

A place where love is supported by **proper safety, space and responsibility**.

That is the place I once wished I had for Chotu.

And that is the place I still hope to create.

“Chotu, I saved your leg. But I could not save you.”

His story remains a reminder that every rescue needs not only compassion, but also space, safety, observation and the ability to respond quickly when a life is at risk.

— A rescuer who still remembers Chotu

CHOTU / KALIA

THE DOG I COULD SAVE,
BUT COULDN'T PROTECT 

A story about love, responsibility,
safety—and the painful lessons
that rescue can teach us.

“

*I saved your leg,
but I could
not save you.”*

– A rescuer who still
remembers Chotu

He trusted me. 
I gave him a second
chance at life.
But I failed to protect
him in the end.



CHOTU'S JOURNEY



THE DAY I FOUND HIM

A young dog with a severely fractured right
rear leg. Tears in his eyes, his mother crying
for help. I couldn't leave him behind.



THE FIGHT TO SAVE HIS LEG

Hospital visits, surgery, and long days
of care in my tiny rented room.
He fought. He healed. He started walking
again—lifting his leg, trusting me.



A LIFE FULL OF LOVE

He became my child. Slept beside me.
Then he met Baby, the goat.
They played, they bonded,
they became family.



TOO MANY LIVES, ONE HEART

I was caring for many dogs and a goat,
managing work and family too.
I dreamed of a safe space for them all.



THE WARNING I MISSED

During mating season, aggression rose.
I saw the signs... but I didn't understand
the danger.



THE MORNING THAT BROKE ME

I found Chotu dead.
His healed leg was injured again.
I had saved him once,
but I couldn't protect him forever.
I buried him that night,
crying and screaming.

WHAT CHOTU TAUGHT ME

Rescue is not only about treatment.
It is also about:

- ▶ Observe behaviour – small signs
can be big warnings.
- ▶ Separate when needed.
- ▶ Provide safe space & isolation.
- ▶ Secure fencing & controlled areas.
- ▶ Quick access to veterinary care.
- ▶ Love must be supported
by safety.

*A rescuer's love must be
stronger than the danger
they cannot see.*

WHY THEY TRUSTED ME

Inside NTPC Barh, I fed 25+ street
dogs every day. With food, water
and love, even the alpha dogs
started trusting me.

They were not animals.
They became family.



THE DREAM THAT REMAINS

My dream is a safe home for rescued lives—with:



Wide secured area
with strong fence
& safe entrance



Weatherproof
isolation space
(6 x 6 ft cage)



Quick access to
veterinary care &
emergency transport



A place where no
rescued animal has
to depend on luck

LET'S BUILD A SAFE HAVEN SO NO **CHOTU** HAS TO DIE AGAIN.

MY PROMISE TO CHOTU

I cannot bring you back.
But I promise—your story
will build a safer future for
many more lives.



PLEASE SUPPORT
OUR RESCUE MISSION 

Food Treatment Shelter Safety

HOW YOU CAN HELP



Monthly Support
(₹ Support)



Medical Aid



Food &
Supplies



Share
Our Story

TOGETHER,
WE CAN TURN PAIN
INTO PROTECTION

